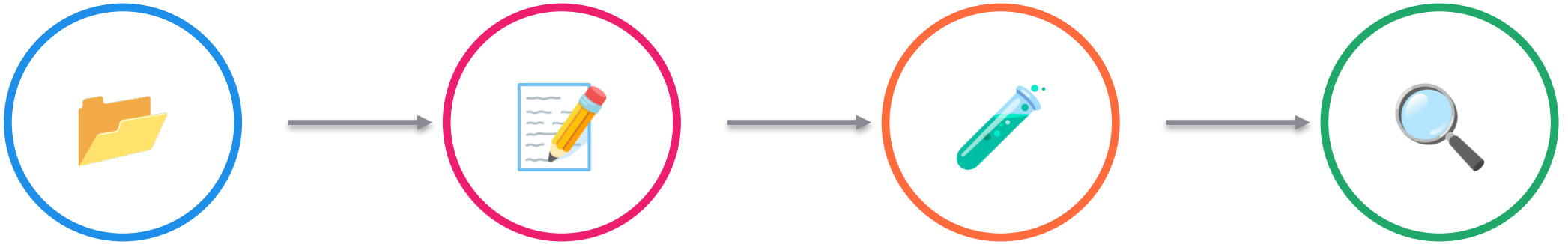
Team Rules for OpenAI Codex with AGENTS.md



Akmal Khan
Senior Full Stack AI Architect
akmalkhaniub.github.io

Author Audition

Meet Codex: OpenAI’s coding agent



Reads your repo

Writes the change

Runs your tests

You review the diff

Give it a task in plain English. It works in your repo like a teammate.

Codex app · CLI · IDE extension. Today: the Codex app on Windows.

Author Audition

Overview



Your smartest teammate forgets everything between tasks.

🤖 Codex memory

your team’s rules

Task done. Memory: empty.

WHAT'S IN IT FOR YOU

Stop leaving the same review comments on Codex’s code.

1 The problem → 2 The fix → 3 The proof

Codex wrote this. Spot the problem.

auth/login.py

```
MAX_ATTEMPTS = 5                                          1
LOCK_MINUTES = 15

def login(email, password):
    if email not in USERS:
        raise LoginError("No account for this email")     2
    if failed[email] >= MAX_ATTEMPTS:
        print(f"Locked out: {email}")                     3
        raise LoginError("Try again in 15 minutes.")
```

🤔 **What would your reviewer say?**

💬 **Review comments**

1. **Limits belong in config.py**
2. **Don’t reveal if an email exists**
3. **Log lockouts with audit_log()**

Why? Every task starts with an empty head.



Task 1: login limit



Task 2: password reset

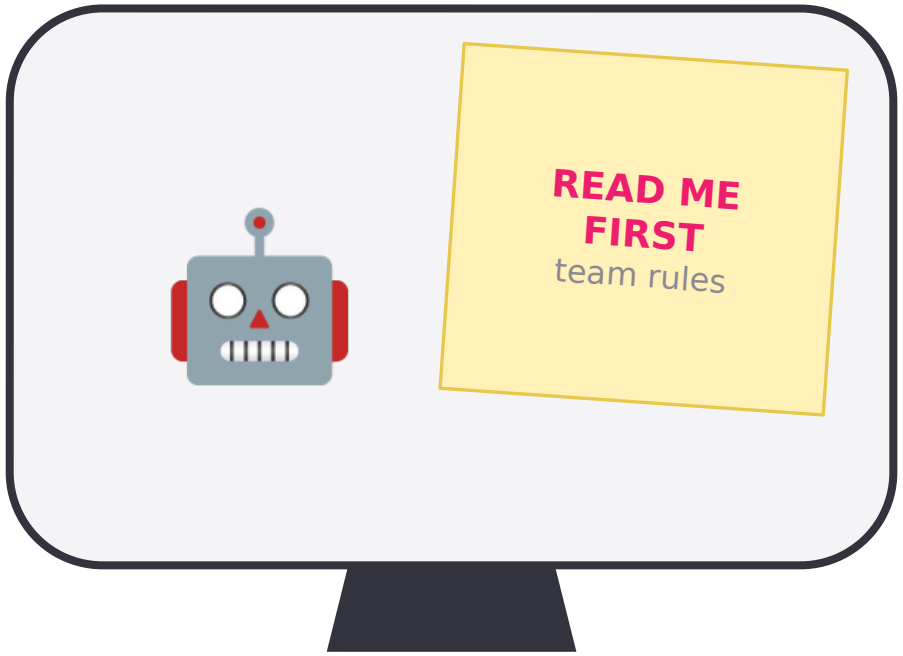


Task 3: sign-up

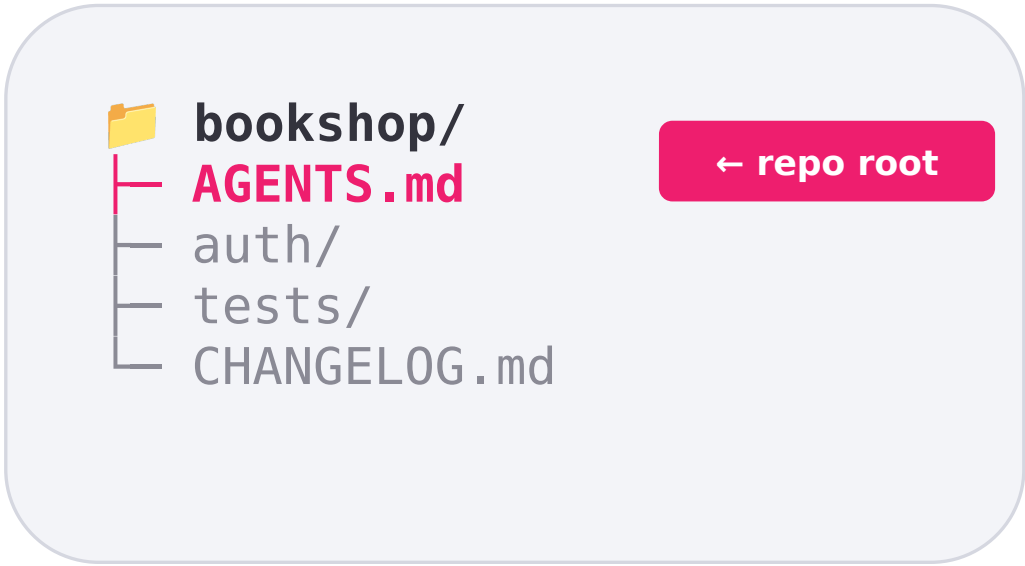
Where your team’s rules live today:

- 🧠 **People’s heads**
- 📄 **Onboarding docs**
- 💬 **Old review threads**
- **✗ Not where Codex looks**

The fix: leave a note where Codex looks first







📖 **Codex reads it before every task**

👥 **Committed in Git: one note for the whole team**

🔄 **Edited it? Start a new thread**

Your review comments ARE the note

FROM THE REVIEW

Limits belong in config.py

Don’t reveal if an email exists

Log lockouts with audit_log()

📝 **AGENTS.md**

```
- Limits (attempts, lock minutes) go in auth/config.py.

- Login errors always say: Invalid email or password.

- Record security events with audit_log(), never print().

- Before finishing, run: python -m unittest discover -s tests
```

Write each comment once, as a rule a reviewer could check in the diff.

Demo



Same prompt.

Without the note, then with it.

1. **No note: ask Codex to add a login limit**
2. **Review the diff: do the stickers come back?**
3. **Add AGENTS.md, new thread, same prompt**
4. **Compare the two diffs**

Same prompt. One file. Zero comments.

Without the note

```
MAX_ATTEMPTS = 5

def login(email, password):

    raise LoginError("No account...")

    print(f"Locked out: {email}")

    ...
```

✗ Limits belong in config.py

✗ Don’t reveal if an email exists

✗ Log lockouts with audit_log()

With AGENTS.md

```
from auth import config

def login(email, password):

    raise LoginError("Invalid email or password.")

    audit_log("LOGIN_LOCKED", email=email)

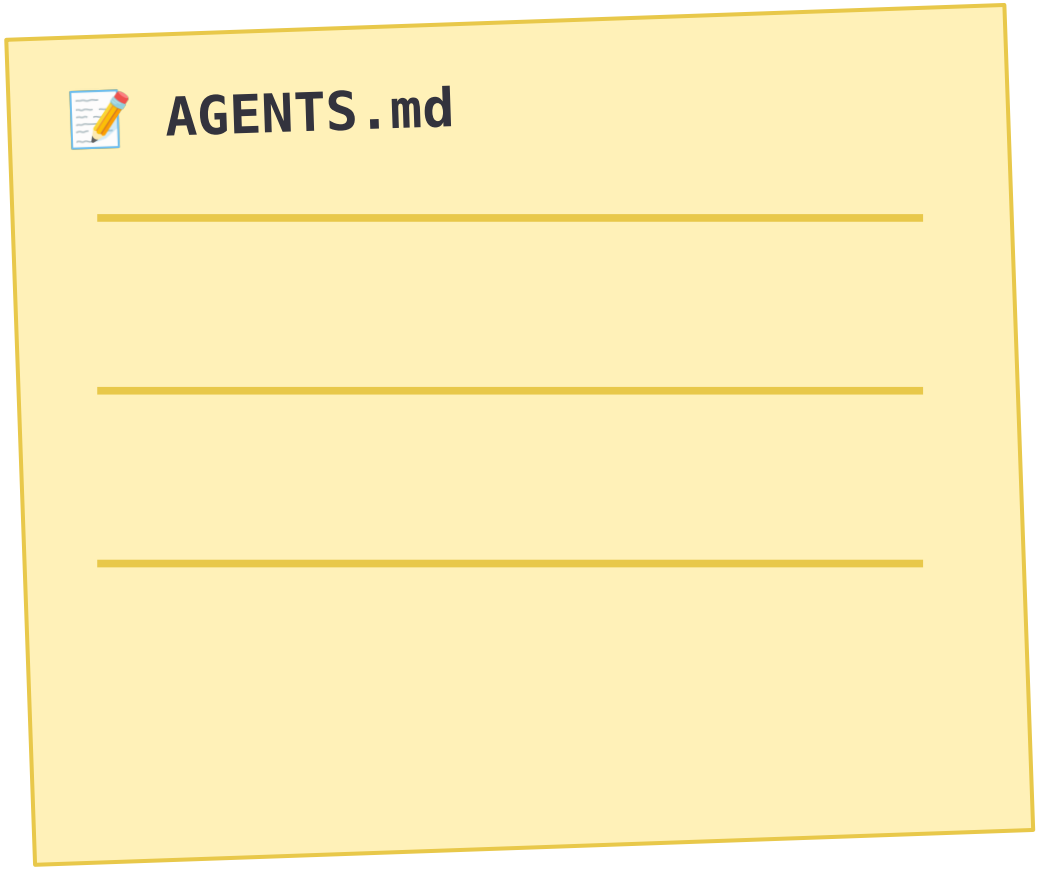
    ...
```

✓ Limits read from config.py

✓ Same message for every failure

✓ Lockout recorded with audit_log()

Your turn: what’s on your team’s note?



💬 **The review comment you type most**

💻 **The command everyone forgets to run**

📄 **The file nobody remembers to update**

Summary



Codex starts every task fresh

AGENTS.md is the note it reads first

Review comments become rules

Rules guide Codex. You still review